Italian Opera in the Age of the American Revolution
With Split the Lark

Monday, October 19, 2026, at 7:00 PM

Opening Remarks

Barbara Faedda
Executive Director and Interim Director
Italian Academy for Advanced Studies in America, Columbia University

Program

Works by Antonio Vivaldi, Giovanni Battista Pergolesi, Georg Frideric Handel, Niccolò Piccinni, and Thomas Arne

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This performance is part of the Italian Academy's series marking the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence. Coming on October 22 is **"Italy and America 250: Cultural Exchange over the Centuries"**—talks by four experts on the thinking and making of music, art, architecture, ideas and books.

AMERICA 250

The Italian Academy for Advanced Studies in America, Columbia University
1161 Amsterdam Avenue, New York, NY 10027
More information: italianacademy.columbia.edu

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY
THE ITALIAN ACADEMY
FOR ADVANCED STUDIES IN AMERICA

Split the Lark presents
Italian Opera in the Age of the American Revolution

Prima Parte: Italianate Style in the Long 17th Century

Alessandro Scarlatti (1660–1725)
Dormi, o fulmine di Guerra, from *La Giuditta* (Rome, 1697)

Antonio Vivaldi (1678–1741)
Gelido in ogni vena, from *Farnace* (Venice, 1731)

G.F. Handel (1685–1759)
Stragi, morti, sangue ed armi, from *Rodrigo* (Florence, 1707)

Giovanni Battista Pergolesi (1710–1736)
Misera e che mi avvenne… Da rio funeste turbine, from *Il Flaminio* (Naples, 1735)

Brief pause

Seconda Parte: American Imports

Thomas Arne (1710–1778)
The Soldier tir'd of wars alarms, from *Artaxerxes* (London, 1762)
American Premiere: Boston, 1778

Thomas Arne (1710-1778)
Thou like the glorious sun, from *Artaxerxes* (London, 1762)
American Premiere: New York City, 1767

G.F. Handel (1685–1759)
O Sleep, why dost thou leave me, from *Semele* (London 1744)

Niccolò Piccinni (1720-1800)
Furie di donna irata, from *La buona figliuola* (Rome, 1760)
American Premiere: New York City, 1786

Split the Lark is a baroque ensemble led by singers. In our performances of repertoire from 1600-1800, we believe the vocal line clearly declaimed by a skilled soloist contains the necessary musical information to lead an ensemble.

After meeting at the Cesti Baroque Competition in Innsbruck, Austria, American singers Morgan Mastrangelo and Sarah Fleiss were troubled by the rarity of singers in positions of leadership within baroque music, particularly within ensembles that purport to specialize in baroque opera. Indeed, out of 50 major ensembles sourced from advertisements and features within *Early Music America* (2026), only 4 vocalist-founded or vocalist-directed organizations could be found on paper. The institutional dearth of singers in leadership positions has, we believe, accompanied a persistent unfamiliarity with the methods and historical principles necessary for successful operatic singing in the baroque style. Split the Lark was founded to uplift and model these principles on the highest possible level. Drawing from cumulative soundings of 17th and 18th century repertoire throughout history – both historical and speculative – Split the Lark approaches canonical repertoire with a spirit of experimentation, taking vocal inspiration from all eras of music, up to and including the early 20th century. splitthelark.co

Performers

Sarah Fleiss



Described as “bright” and “stylish” by Opera News and “sparkling” by BachTrack, soprano Sarah Fleiss is a laureate of the 12th edition of Le Jardin des Voix with Les Arts Florissants where she toured internationally as La Poésie in *Les arts florissants* and Proserpine in *La Descente d'Orphée aux Enfers* with William Christie. On tour, she enjoyed debuts at the Philharmonie Luxembourg, the Lucerne Festival, Opéra Royal de Versailles, Philharmonie de Paris, Opéra de Massy, Auditorio Nacional Madrid, Auditorium-Orchestre National de Lyon, Opera Palau de les Arts Reina Sofia, the Auditorio Principe Felipe Oviedo, the Toronto Summer Music Festival, the Festival de Lanaudière, the Tanglewood Music Festival, Caramoor, Auditorium Giovanni Agnelli, Teatro del Verme, and the Festival d'Ambronay. This season, she sings the Beethoven *Mass in C* with the Binghamton Symphony, Handel’s *Messiah* with the Wichita Symphony, Handel’s *Esther* with Mountainside Baroque, Mozart’s *Exsultate, Jubilate* with the Sarasota Orchestra, and Liszt’s *Missa Solemnis* with the Montgomery County Chorale. On the opera stage, she debuts with Opera Philadelphia in the world premiere of *Sitcom* and with Opera Lafayette in an immersive pastiche of English Baroque arias. She recently debuted at the Monteverdi Festival Cremona singing La Fortuna and Damigella in *L'incoronazione di Poppea* and sang in the Les Arts Florissants spring and summer festivals. Operatic roles include Susanna in *Le Nozze di Figaro*, the Vixen in Janáček's *The Cunning Little Vixen* and Ginevra in Handel’s *Ariodante*. Concert highlights include the *Fauré Requiem*, Brahms’ *Ein Deutsches Requiem*, the Dvořák *Te Deum*, and Poulenc’s *Gloria*. A devoted recitalist, she has presented programs at Strathmore Mansion, Washington Performing Arts, Artist Series Concerts of Sarasota, 92NY, Spivey Hall, Library of Congress, Brevard Music Center, Harvard Musical Association, Woodmere Art Museum, Thomas Jefferson University, and Trust Performing Arts Center. Sarah attended the Curtis Institute of Music, Columbia University, and the Juilliard School, and also trained at the Verbier Festival, the Aspen Music Festival, and the Georg Solti Accademia. With a background in musical theater, she strives for authenticity as a singer-actor, regardless of genre.

sarahfleiss.com

Morgan Mastrangelo



Hailed as “Terrific” by *The New York Times,* Morgan Mastrangelo is a former Emerging Artist with Boston Lyric Opera, now based in New York. This season, they make principal debuts with Boston Lyric Opera as Ruodi in *Guillaume Tell.* Don Ramiro in *La Cenerentola* with the Boston Youth Symphony Orchestra, and the tenor soloist in Handel’s *Messiah* at Duke Chapel. Recent credits include Astolfe in Lully's *Roland* at Opéra Royal Versailles with the period instrument orchestra i Gemelli, Madeline X in Michael Gordon's opera *What to Wear* at Beth Morrison Projects' PROTOTYPE Festival (NYC), Hades in *Eurydice* at Opera Grand Rapids, Count Almaviva in Il *Barbiere di Siviglia* (Wichita Grand Opera), and Frederic in *The Pirates of Penzance* (New York Gilbert and Sullivan Players). Active on the concert stage, they recently sang the tenor solo in Bach's BWV 92 with conductor Harry Bicket for Bach Vespers New York, as well as the solo cantata for tenor *Ich armer Mensch, ich Sündenknecht*. They debuted with Boston Baroque as the tenor soloist in Bach's *Coffee Cantata, BWV 211,* and have a long-standing relationship with Emmanuel Music in their weekly Bach Cantata series, singing the tenor solos in over 15 cantatas with the group. Other concert credits include Handel's Messiah (Messiah Choral Society of Orlando) and Orff's Carmina Burana (Carnegie Hall). They are a 2026 Sullivan Foundation Award Winner, and have also won prizes at the 2025 Concours du chant Baroque Froville, Handel Aria Competition, American National Oratorio Competition, and the 2024 Lyndon-Woodside Oratorio Competition. They are an alumnus of the Young Artist Programs of Opera Saratoga and Teatro Nuovo and earned degrees from Northwestern University and New England Conservatory.

morganmastrangelo.com

Austin Philemon



Austin Philemon is an organist, pianist, conductor, and composer based in New York City. He has had the opportunity to perform solo recitals domestically including at the Cathedral of St. John the Divine, St. Paul’s Chapel at Trinity Wall Street, and the Church of St. Mary the Virgin in Times Square, as well as abroad in Paris, France; Graz, Austria; Romainmôtier, Switzerland; Haarlem, Netherlands; Modena, Italy; Höganäs, Sweden; Gdánsk Poland; and Manchester, UK. He recently placed third in the Sweelinck International Organ Competition in Gdánsk, Poland, and has been selected as a finalist in several major improvisation competitions including the National Competition in Organ Improvisation and the University of Michigan Organ Improvisation Competition, and also received first prize in the George R. Mathison Memorial Competition.

As an advocate for new organ music, Austin has premiered over 40 works for organ, served as consultant for countless more, and is passionate about educating composers on how to write for the organ. As a composer of both traditional, electro-acoustic, and performance art works, Austin collaborates frequently with experimental artists. Upcoming partnerships include the premiere of his piano quartet, The Fermi Paradox with The Why Collective. As a conductor, Austin has appeared with the American Modern Orchestra, the Brooklyn Chamber orchestra, and the Bach Choir and Orchestra of Holy Trinity. Austin graduated in 2019 with the Master of Music degree in Organ Performance from the Manhattan School of Music where he studied with Dr. Andrew Henderson. In 2017, he graduated summa cum laude as a Levine Scholar from the University of North Carolina at Charlotte where he double-majored in German and Organ Performance, helping to found the university’s organ program with his teacher, Dr. Jacqueline Yost. Austin currently serves as Director of Music at Holy Trinity Lutheran Church.
austinphilemon.com

Jules Biber



Jules Biber is a cellist, educator and musical curator based in Brooklyn, NY. An accomplished chamber musician and soloist, Jules' versatility in early, standard and modern repertoire, as well as non-classical styles, makes them sought-after for a variety of high-profile concerts and recording projects, and their deep commitment to inclusive community has made them one of the city's progressive curators of classical music spaces.

Jules believes strongly in creating environments for classical music that are free from the concert hall's antiquated aesthetics. Their first series, Classical at Pete's at Pete's Candy Store in Williamsburg (later Branded Classical at Branded Saloon), created a platform for performers and composers to present their work with the freedom to experiment, in an environment that was equally welcoming to the listener. Classical at Pete's/Branded Classical was home to a wide variety of performers, including members of the Metropolitan Opera Orchestra, International Contemporary Ensemble, and New York Philharmonic Orchestra.

In 2019, Jules co-founded ChamberQUEER, an LGBTQ+ chamber music organization devoted to presenting and performing queer composers and musicians and highlighting historical queer figures in classical music. Based in Brooklyn, NY, it is in its seventh season of events serving the greater NYC community by creating an alternative, inclusive space within the classical music scene, supported in part by the Brooklyn Arts Fund and New Music USA. It has received write-ups in the New Yorker and New Music Box, and been presented by Death of Classical, WQXR at the Greene Space, Boulanger Initiative, and Brooklyn Pride.

julesbiber.com

Marguerite Cox



Marguerite Cox, a double bassist from northeast Ohio, is a versatile and in-demand collaborator in numerous musical settings throughout the United States. A recent alumna of Carnegie Hall's Ensemble Connect fellowship, Maggie has recently appeared with Palaver Strings, Baroklyn, Jupiter Symphony Chamber Players, The Knights, East Coast Chamber Orchestra, Ruckus Early Music and the Salt Lake Chamber Orchestra. As an orchestral musician, she has appeared as a substitute with the Baltimore and Charleston Symphonies, held the principal bass position at Symphony in C from 2022 to 2024, and was a member of the 2023 Cabrillo Festival Orchestra, the 2025 Teatro Nuovo Orchestra, and the inaugural NYO All-Stars Orchestra.

In 2024, Maggie toured and recorded extensively with experimental folk band Big Bend in collaboration with producer and musician Shahzad Izmaily. In 2026, Relative Pitch Records released Keep Telling Yourself That, an album of original music by Goal Weight, Maggie's project with violinist Jennifer Gersten. Marguerite received her undergraduate degree at Rice University's Shepherd School and her master's at the Curtis Institute, where she was the first bassist to receive that degree. In 2016, inspired by studies within Rice's Poverty, Justice, and Human Capabilities program, she founded the Ohio-based Artists for Action, through which she organizes community benefit concerts and other funding initiatives for local organizations. margueritecox.com

Ryan Closs



Ryan Closs is a Long Island based specialist of Historical Plucked Strings Performance. He is a requested performer for Operas, Cantatas, and Orchestras who has gained much attention for his work with dancers, singers, and chamber ensembles. Ryan's duties as an outreach soloist for the Lute Society of America have earned him a title as the head of its NY chapter. His outreach performances have contributed to the growing knowledge and appreciation of the Lute, its times, and its music, a mission he continues and expands upon with his own period ensembles '*4&20Strings*' and '*Early Music Long Island*'. In 2022 Ryan and his wife, Mackenzie, began the launch of a pseudo-virtual artistic manifold titled '*Shoebox Opera*'.

As an avid enthusiast of early music practices, Ryan participates in many outreach concerts bringing the Lute to new audiences performing traditional music, complimented with new contemporary folk songs in a universal Troubador fashion. In an effort to involve his community he formed Early Music Long Island, a community based ensemble that performs songs using ground bass progressions and improvised divisions. He is also recognized as an 'ambassador' for the Lute Society of America (LSA) as an outreach performer, and Head of the New York Chapter of the LSA (LSA-NY). His Baroque ensemble (4&20 Strings) continues with the virtue of encouraging new audiences to be active and informed listeners.

Ryan has an A.A.S in Classical Guitar performance from SUNY Nassau Community College, a B.S. in Lute Studies from Adelphi University, and studied for a while at CUNY Queens College before completing his Bachelors. His primary instructors for these degrees have been Steve Leonard, Bill Zito, Chris Morrongiello, & Pat O'Brien

ryancloss.com

Ian Jones



New York-based classical and baroque violinist Ian Jones has traveled throughout the world, performing a range of repertoire from Medieval to contemporary works. He has performed with the world's leading figures in early music, including Rachel Podger, William Christie, Masaaki Suzuki, Shunske Sato, Lionel Meunier, among others.
His engagements include concerts with ensembles such as the New York Baroque Incorporated, Teatro Nuovo, Les Arts Florissants, the English Concert, Juilliard415, Tafelmusik, the Sebastians, MAFestival Bruges, ARTEK Early Music, the Baroque Chamber Orchestra of Colorado, as well as at the American Bach Soloists and the Oregon Bach Festival academies. Most recently, he was selected as a 2025 fellow with the English Concert in America.
Ian holds a bachelor's degree in music performance from The University of Georgia, as well as a master's degree from The University of Denver. Ian recently graduated with a master's degree in baroque violin from the Juilliard School's Historical Performance program.

Grace McKenzie



Grace McKenzie is an artist, violinist, and baroque violinist from Aotearoa NZ. Currently pursuing Historical Performance at the Juilliard School, she first came to the USA to study at Indiana University. She has since performed at the Carmel Bach Festival, attended the Avaloch Farm Institute, and taught violin on a music education mission in the Dominican Republic. Grace seeks collaboration with artists and musicians from diverse perspectives of culture and training, aiming to break down traditional audience-performer boundaries in classical music and broaden its reach. Grace is also a photographer, lover of all things creative and enjoys finding ways to weave these things into her career as a musician.

Gracie Carney



Violinist and violist Gracie Carney moves fluidly between historical, contemporary, and popular musical spheres. She completed her studies at Indiana University and McGill University and is currently pursuing historical violin studies at The Juilliard School. A passionate educator, Carney has held teaching residencies at the University of Maryland, Catholic University of America, and Towson University. Her artistic residencies include the Women Composers Conference, WoCo Fest, and the Contemporary Composers Institute. Her scholarly research on Mozart's embellishments has been published by Cambridge University Press. In collaboration with composer and performer Dan Deacon, Carney can be heard on the soundtracks for Marvel's *Venom*, HBO's *Task*, and *Orwell 2+2=5*. As a member of the ensemble Mind on Fire, she has performed in collaboration with BalletX and been featured on WNYC.

Ezra Gans



Ezra Gans is a bassoonist and composer based in Astoria, New York. His work straddles the worlds of historically informed performance and experimental improvisation, interweaving instruments and musical techniques of the past and present to create music that examines our relationship with history. Aside from performing on bassoons, clarinets, and recorders of various shapes and sizes, Ezra incorporates live electronics, spoken word, and even, on occasion, amateurish dance into his works.As a historical bassoonist, Ezra has performed extensively around the United States and the world, including with Les Arts Florissants in Thiré, France, at the Charlotte and Oregon Bach Festivals, and as a featured soloist with Juilliard415. He is a member of slapslap, a performance-art-rock band consisting of two electric bassoons and two drummers, and BRIGE, a group alternatingly known as "a multidisciplinary experiment in radical geometry" and "just four friends." ezragans.com

Emi Ostrom



Emi Ostrom is an oboe player and vocalist originally from Columbia, Maryland. A graduate of Juilliard's Historical Performance Program, she is the recipient of a Juilliard Career Advancement Grant, a fellowship from The English Concert in America, and a Music Advancement Program fellowship. She can be heard playing historical oboes and recorders around the country with acclaimed ensembles including Seraphic Fire, ARTEK, Clarion, Holy Trinity Bach Vespers, Early Music New York, and Kollective366. Ostrom, a mezzo-soprano, has recently sung with ARTEK, St. James Compostela Choir and the Lux Choir in Princeton. An avid educator, she is the Chair of Creative Musicianship and Composition at the Thurnauer School of Music, where she teaches music theory and composition classes, and a summer faculty member at the Walden School where she teaches several courses and performs with members of the International Contemporary Ensemble.

Gillian Bobnak

Gillian Bobnak is an American oboist who specializes in historical and modern oboes. She studied with Antoine Torunczyk at the Conservatoire à rayonnement régional de Paris and holds degrees from the New England Conservatory, where she was a student of Mark McEwen, and the Juilliard School, where she studied with Gonzalo Ruiz. At Juilliard, she worked with a wide array of esteemed faculty and guest artists, including William Christie, Paul Agnew, Jakob Lehmann, Lionel Meunier, Rachel Podger, Laurence Cummings, Peter Whelan, Laurence Equilbey, and Masaaki Suzuki. She has performed throughout the United States with groups such as the Oregon Bach Festival, the Chamber Orchestra of Philadelphia, the San Francisco Early Music Festival with Vox Luminis, and Symphony in C. In the summer of 2023, she received a grant from the Netherlands-America Foundation to pursue a brief period of study with oboist Frank de Bruine at Koninklijk Conservatorium den Haag, and received a full scholarship for a week of study at the Vielklang Festival in Tübingen, Germany. Her interests include the performance of 17th and 18th century sacred German music, especially the vocal works of Johann Sebastian Bach and his predecessors; historical woodwind improvisation; early recordings and their relation to performance practice research; and France's influence on the modern American oboe sound.



Bryce McClendon, Vocal Consultant

Bryce McClendon is a voice teacher, performer, and playwright based in New York City. Her students have performed with prestigious companies and orchestras worldwide. This list includes: the Metropolitan Opera · Festival d'Aix-en-Provence · Glyndebourne Opera · the Salzburg Festival · Chateau de Versailles · La Monnaie/De Munt · Opéra national de Montpellier · Opéra de Lyon · Opéra de Lille · Grand Théâtre de Genève · Bayerische Staatsoper · English National Opera · Santa Fe Opera · Seattle Opera · Michigan Opera Theater · Boston Lyric Opera · Florida Grand Opera · St. Petersburg Opera · Sarasota Opera · Chicago Lyric Opera · Wolf Trap Opera · Washington National Opera · Teatro Nuovo · the Boston Symphony Orchestra · the Cleveland Orchestra · the Chicago Symphony Orchestra · the New York Philharmonic · Apollo's Fire · American Bach Soloists · Boston Early Music Festival · Boston Baroque · Handel & Haydn Society · Philharmonia Baroque Orchestra · Portland Baroque Orchestra · L'Arpeggiata · Seraphic Fire Collegium 1704 · Danish National Opera · the Royal Opera House in Covent Garden · and the Gewandhaus in Leipzig. Her students have performed at Carnegie Hall and Wigmore Hall, and have received honors from the Metropolitan Opera Laffont Competition, the Handel Aria Competition, the Gerda Lissner Vocal Competition, the Froville International Baroque Singing Competition, the Camille Coloratura Competition, the Oratorio Society of New York, the Musicians Club of Women, and others.



Dormi, O fulmine di guerra - Scarlatti - La Giuditta (1693)

Dormi, o fulmine di guerra	Sleep, O thunderbolt of war;
Scorda, l'ire!	Forget your wrath!
Già provasti ch'a ferire l''arco e il dardo	You have already learned that the bow and arrow
D'un bel ciglio, d'un bel guardo	Of a lovely brow, of a lovely gaze,
Han vigor che i forti atterra	Possess a power that strikes down the mighty.

Gelido in ogni vena - Vivaldi - Farnace (1727)

Gelido in ogni vena	I feel my blood
Scorrer mi sento il sangue.	Running ice-cold in every vein.
L'ombra del figlio esangue	The shadow of my lifeless son
M'ingombra di terror.	Fills me with terror.
E per maggior mia pena	And to my greater torment,
Vedo che fui crudele	I see that I was cruel
A un'anima innocente	To an innocent soul—
Al core del mio cor.	To the very heart of my heart.

Stragi, morti, sangue ed armi - Handel - Rodrigo (1707)

Stragi, morti, sangue ed armi	Massacres, death, bloodshed, and arms—
Con bellici carmi Già grida la tromba.	With martial strains, the trumpet already blares.
Flagellato dal mio sdegno, Arda un regno;	Scourged by my wrath, let a kingdom burn;
Già, già d'alte rovine Il ciel rimbomba	Already the heavens resound with the crash of mighty ruins.

Da rio funeste in turbine - Pergolesi - Il Flaminio (1737)

Recitativo

Misera! E che m'avvenne?	Wretched me! What has befallen me?
E chi pensato a tai disavventure avria giammai?	And who could ever have imagined such misfortunes?
Per amar Giulio, a Ferdinando io manco, e manco al mio dover:	For loving Giulio, I fail Ferdinand and fail my duty:
Soffro rimproveri e rampogne e minacce; e poi qual frutto?	I endure reproaches, rebukes, and threats; and what is the fruit of it all?
Giulio è così ostinato, Giulio è per me sì ingrato!	Giulio is so obstinate; Giulio is so ungrateful to me!
O qual rimorso! qual rosso! qual dispetto!	Oh, what remorse! What shame! What vexation!
O qual orrore! Che far mi debbo? Oimè mi manca il core.	Oh, what horror! What am I to do? Alas, my heart fails me.

Aria

Da rio funesto turbine	By a cruel, baleful whirlwind
di pensier tristi ed orridi	of sad and dreadful thoughts
coprir mi veggo l'animo;	I see my soul engulfed;
sento da me dividere	I feel my very spirit
smarrito ogni mio spirito,	torn from me in bewilderment—
oh Dio, questo è morir.	Oh God, this is like dying.
Ah! dove son? chi guidami? che penso? chi consigliami?	Ah! Where am I? Who guides me? What am I thinking? Who counsels me?
Stelle!... Ma sorde e barbare son fatte al mio martir.	Stars!... Yet they remain deaf and cruel to my torment.

Pause

The soldier tir'd of wars alarms - Thomas Arne - *Artaxerxes* (1762)

The soldier, tired of war's alarms,
forswears the clang of hostile arms,
and scorns the spear and shield:
but if the brazen trumpet sound,
he burns with conquest to be crown'd,
and dares again the field.

Thou like the glorious sun - Thomas Arne - *Artaxerxes* (1762)
Thou, like the glorious sun,
thy splendid course shalt run:
what tho' the night
obscure his light,
when prison'd in the west;
the day returns,
again he burns,
the god of day confest.

O sleep, why dost thou leave me - Handel - *Semele* (1744)
Oh sleep, why dost thou leave me?
Why thy visionary joys remove?

Oh sleep, again deceive me,
to my arms restore my wand'ring love!

Furie di donna irata - Piccinni - *La Buona Figliuola* (1760)

Furie di donna irata
in mio soccorso invoco.
Ah che mi accresce il foco
un disperato amor.

Resa per un'ingrata
gioco d'avversa sorte
straggi, vendetta e morte
medita il mio furor.

Furies of an enraged woman
I call to come to my aid.
Ah, a desperate love
only fans the flames within me.

Victim of an ungrateful woman,
the sport of adverse fate
carnage, vengeance, and death.
My fury contemplates.